CYBER MIND SPACE

OSINT Excellence Cheat Sheet

The complete open-source intelligence reference — from foundations to advanced investigations.

Part 1–2 Foundations & Analyst Skills	**Part 3** SearchEngines & Operators	**Part 4–5** Resources, Tools & Collections
Part 6 OPSEC& Operational Security	**Tools** Email · Phone · Dark Web · SOCMINT	**Exec** Executive Protection & VIP Security
Skills OSINTTips · Soft Skills	**AI** AI+ OSINT Strategies & Tools	**Jobs** 60High-Demand OSINT Careers
Europe EuropeanBusiness Data	**Advanced** Platforms,Brand Intelligence	**Ext** Browser Extensions · 40 Communities

DISCLAIMER This guide is intended for educational and career development purposes only. All advice reflects the author's professional experience. Always conduct your own due diligence.

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◆PART 1 & 2 ·

Foundations — Intelligence Cycle & OSINT Basics

The Intelligence Cycle

1	2	3	4	5
Planning & Direction	**Collection**	**Processing**	**Analysis & Production**	**Dissemination**
Plan, strategize, research, discuss, gather intelligence, execute task efficiently.	Gather intelligence overtly and covertly utilizing various technological resources.	Compile collected data into intelligence reports.	Analyze data, determine relevance, anticipate outcomes, evaluate impact on interests.	Deliver analysis to policymaker, await feedback, restart cycle as necessary.

What is OSINT?

OSINT stands for Open Source Intelligence — the practice of collecting and analyzing information from publicly available sources to gather insights, identify trends, or generate intelligence.

Top Sources

- People identifiers (names, emails, phones)
- Social media platforms (Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, LinkedIn, TikTok)
- News articles — traditional & online
- Government reports & publications
- Websites — text, images, videos, documents, metadata
- Blogs & Forums — opinions, discussions, user content

OSINT Purposes

Security & Threat Intelligence: Identifying security risks through analyzing public information.

Investigations: Conducting investigations by gathering relevant information.

Competitive Intelligence: Gathering info about competitors and market trends.

Reputation Management: Monitoring and managing online reputation of individuals and organizations.

Journalism & Research: Gathering data to uncover facts, verify claims, and provide context.

Disaster Response: Assessing impact of natural disasters, conflicts or crises.

Main Users

Governments

Community sentiment · Risk & threats · Weather & disaster · Trending activities · Critical information

Corporations

Personnel protection · Due diligence · Fraud investigations · Supply chain risk · Brand monitoring

Law Enforcement

Crisis response · Counter violent extremism · Situational awareness · Public safety · Deep investigations

Investigators & Journalists

Verification · Investigative journalism · Private investigation · Uncover facts · Access data

Top Free OSINT Tools

◆Web Archive	◆HaveIBeenPwned	◆Epieos	◆Namechk
◆Inteltechniques	◆Forensic OSINT	◆FOCA	◆OpenCorporates

Intelligence Analyst Key Skills

1. Critical Thinking	2. Research & Analysis	3. Technical Skills	4. Problem-Solving	5. Communication Skills

Evaluate information critically, considering its reliability, relevance, and implications.	Gather information from a variety of sources and analyze data sets to draw conclusions.	Proficiency in analytical tools, databases, and software for data collection and analysis.	Provide creative and strategic solutions to complex problems.	Convey findings clearly, both in written reports and oral briefings.

Intelligence Disciplines

OSINT Open Source Intelligence	**SOCMINT Social Media Intelligence**	**HUMINT Human Intelligence**
Encompasses accessible information found in various mediums: printed materials, electronic platforms, broadcast media, and online sources.	A branch of OSINT focusing on gathering and analyzing information from social media platforms (posts, images, videos, public conversations).	Involves direct interaction with individuals to collect valuable knowledge or access to sensitive information.
GEOINT Geospatial Intelligence	**IMINT Imagery Intelligence**	**SIGINT Signals Intelligence**
Analysis of geospatial data to understand activities and events on Earth's surface, combining imagery, mapping, and GIS.	Collection, analysis, and interpretation of visual images from satellites, reconnaissance aircraft, drones, and other imaging systems.	Interception and analysis of electronic signals (radio, radar, telecommunications data) and communications for intelligence purposes.

Internet Categories

Surface Web

Normal web visible for all users. Websites indexed by search engines. Represents only 4% of the entire internet.

Deep Web

Not indexed by search engines. Access restricted to authorized users. Databases, cloud storage, sensitive data.

Dark Web

Access through software like Tor Browser. Anonymous browsing. Illegal activities are promoted.

Computer Optimization

Antivirus

Software to detect, prevent, and remove malware from computers and networks (Windows Defender, ClamAV, Avast).

VPN

Creates a secure connection over the internet, encrypting your traffic (ProtonVPN, NordVPN, CyberGhost).

Virtual Machines (VM)

Software-based emulations of physical computers allowing multiple OS to run concurrently (Kali Linux, Trace Labs, Silo, Tsurugi).

Web Browsers

Primary tool for OSINT investigations (Brave, Firefox, Tor). Use with extensions for enhanced capability.

Sock Puppets

Fake online identities for investigation purposes (FakePersonGenerator, ThisPersonDoesNotExist, ChatGPT, AI).

Top Browser Extensions

- uBlock Origin
- Cookie AutoDelete
- Google Translate
- RevEye
- Privacy Badger
- DownThemAll
- Exif Viewer
- Vortimo
- Instant Data Scraper
- Wayback Machine
- FireShot
- Context Search
- User-Agent Switcher
- Sputnik

◆PART 3 ·

Search Engines & Operators

General Search Engines

Google The world's most widely used search engine.	**Bing** Microsoft's engine — useful for images and video.	**Yandex** Dominant in Russia, strong for Cyrillic content.	**Baidu** Dominant in China, essential for Chinese-language searches.	**Yahoo** Legacy engine still useful for people searches.
Ask Question-based search engine.	**Aol** Legacy engine occasionally surfacing older results.	**Brave** Privacy-focused search engine with independent index.	**Qwant** European privacy-respecting search engine.	**DuckDuckGo** Privacy-focused, no tracking or personalization.

Search Operators

Operator	Description	Example	
"Quotation Marks"	Search for the exact word or phrase.	"Joe Doe"	
AND	Find info related to both X and Y.	"OSINT" AND "Training"	
OR	Find info relating to either X or Y.	"Apple" OR "Microsoft"	
Hyphen (-)	Exclude words from the search.	Jaguar Speed -Car	
Asterisk (*)	Use * as a wildcard matching any word/phrase.	OSINT * Cheat Sheets	
Range (..)	Search between two identifiers.	Crime rate "2000..2024"	
site:	Find results from a specific domain.	site:linkedin.com	
filetype:	Search for files with a specified extension.	"OSINT" filetype:pdf	
related:	Find pages related to a given domain.	related:osintframework.com	
inurl:	Locate pages with a word in their URL.	inurl:OSINT	
intitle:	Locate pages with a word in their title.	intitle:OSINT	
intext:	Locate pages with a word in their content.	intext:OSINT	

Key Search Factors

1. Use multiple search engines to improve and maximize results.	2. Use search operators and the Advanced Search function.

3. Use international search engines (Baidu in China, Yandex in Russia).	4. Use different name variants (United States, US, USA, America).
5. Use different spellings (München, Munich).	6. Perform searches in multiple languages and locations.
7. Use multiple types of data (names, phones, emails, addresses).	

Dark Web Search Engines

Dark Web Engines	Specialized Search Engines
THW (The Hidden Wiki)	OCCRP Aleph
Ahmia.fi	Intelx.io
Torch	Shodan
Haystak	Carrot2
Not Evil	Isearchfrom
Tor.link	2lingual
DuckDuckGo (onion)	Academia
	Internet Archive
	Newspaper Archive
	Search Engine Colossus

◆PART 4 & 5 ·

Resources & Tools Collections

Essential Books

1. OSINT Techniques — Michael Bazzell	2. Deep Dive — Rae Baker
3. Hunting Cyber Criminals — Vinny Troia	4. OSINT Methods and Tools — Nihad A. Hassan & Rami Hijazi
5. We Are Bellingcat — Eliot Higgins	6. How to Find Out Anything — Don MacLeod
7. Operator Handbook — Joshua Picolet	8. OSINT: The Art of Collecting Open Information — David Anderson

Virtual Machines & Environments

Inteltechniques VM	Sherlock Linux VM	Kali Linux VM	Trace Labs OSINT VM
CSI Linux VM	Tsurugi VM	OSINTUX VM	Silo (isolated online investigations)
Kasm (remote desktop)	Debian (optimal Linux OS)	Tails (privacy-centered OS)	

Podcasts · YouTube Channels · Telegram Groups · Newsletters

Podcasts	YouTube	Telegram	Newsletters
Security Now	Cyber Detective	Bellingcat EN	OSINT Jobs
NeedleStack	Nixintel	Brigada OSINT	Gralhix
Shadow Dragon	Sector035	Soxoj Insides	Bendobrown
The Pivot	Intel Techniques	OSINT Losena	Sofia Santos
The OSINT Bunker	Offensive OSINT	OSINT Anatomy	Skopenow Blog
News Snapshots	OSINT Combine	Cyber Detective	Blackdot Blog
Layer 8	VEEXH Medium	OSINT Teame	Dutch OSINT Guy
The World of Intelligence	CQcore	OsintTV	Shadow Dragon
	SANS Institute	Cyber Hunter	David Bombal
	LISA Institute	OSINT Israel	Digital Investigations
	OSINTME	GINSEG	Forensic OSINT
	OSINT Curious	Ciberpatrulla	Fog Of Influence
	Gary Ruddell	OSINT Excellence	My OSINT News

	OSINT Dojo	Digital Digging	OSINT Ambition
			The OSINT Newsletter
			OSINT Insider

OSINT Collections

OSINT Framework	UK OSINT	OSINT Essentials
IntelTechniques Search Tools	Aware Online Tools	Toddington
OSINT For Finding People	Andy Black Associates	OSINT Dojo Resources
OSINT Toolkit	Reuser's Repertorium	Malfrat's OSINT Map
IntelligenceX Tools	Achirou OSINT Tools	Meta OSINT
Bellingcat Online Toolkit	OH SHINT! Web Resources	SPJ Toolbox
OSINT Combine Free Tools	The OSINTion Wiki	OSINT Techniques Tools

Spreadsheets

Bellingcat's Investigation Toolkit	https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/18rtqh8EG2q1xBo2cLNyhIDuK9jrPGwYr9DI2UncoqJQ
OSINT For Finding People	https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1JxBbMt4JvGr--G0PkI3jP9VDTBunR2uD3_faZXDvhxc
Aaron CTI's OSINT Collection	https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1klugQqw6POlBtuzon8S0b18-gpsDwX-5OYRrB7TyNEw

Handbooks

Toddington	https://www.toddington.com/resources/cheat-sheets/
I-Intelligence OSINT Handbook 2020	https://i-intelligence.eu/uploads/public-documents/OSINT_Handbook_2020.pdf
Aljazeera Media Institute Open Source Investigation Handbook	https://institute.aljazeera.net/sites/default/files/2023/
Blackdot Solutions — The OSINT Handbook	https://blackdotsolutions.com/wp-content/uploads/2021/11/The-OSINT-Handbook_.pdf
The Intelligence Handbook (Recorded Future)	https://go.recordedfuture.com/the-intelligence-handbook-fourth-edition

Bookmarks

OSINT Stack (OSINT Combine)	https://www.osintcombine.com/free-osint-tools/osint-bookmark-stack
Dark Web OSINT Stack	https://www.osintcombine.com/free-osint-tools/darkweb-bookmark-stack

GitHub Repositories

Awesome OSINT	OSINT Encyclopedia	OhShINT
Sinwindie OSINT Dojo	OSINT For Countries	Ph055a OSINT
Datajournalism Resources	Non Typical OSINT Guide	Soxoj
Offensive OSINT Tools	Awesome Social Engineering	Cyber Detective
Daniel Durnea FBI Tools	OSINT Team Links	

◆PART 6 ·

OPSEC — Operational Security

What is OPSEC?

Operational Security (OPSEC)is a systematic process that identifies and protects sensitive information from adversaries to prevent exploitation, maintain anonymity, and keep activities undetected.

OPSEC = software + hardware + practices

Key Considerations

■ OPSEC should always be practiced, regardless of how trivial an investigation might seem.	■OPSEC needs to be tailored to the activity or investigation.
■Assume online activities are being monitored at all times.	■ OPSEC is a continuous practice that should become second nature.
■Continuously adapt as new threats and techniques emerge.	■ Continuously assess potential risks before sharing any information, whether online or offline.
■ Keep research separate from personal and professional activities.	■Research OSINT tools thoroughly before use.

VPNs · Sock Puppets · Phones & Emails

VPNs

■Useful to mask your true IP address and location.

■Prevents tracking by websites and services.

■Enhances privacy when conducting research.

■Recommended: ProtonVPN, NordVPN, CyberGhost.

Sock Puppets

■Protects real identity during investigations.

■Avoids detection by target entities.

■Gathers information without raising suspicion.

■Tools: Fake Name Generator, ThisPersonDoesNotExist, ChatGPT.

Phones & Emails

■Prevents traceability to your real identity.

■Reduces risk of account linkage detection.

■Enhances security from potential breaches.

■Tools: Hushed, Protonmail, Tutanota.

Web Browsers & Password Management

Browser	Browser Ad -ons
Firefox Open-source, customizable, strong privacy extensions.	■ Tool for secure, local password management. ■ HTTPS Everywhere ■ uBlock Origin ■ Privacy Badger
Brave Built-in ad and tracker blocker, privacy-first.	■ Same extensions as Firefox plus Brave's built-in shields. ■ Improves security and simplifies management.
TOR Browser Anonymizes traffic via the Tor network.	■M iOnipmeinz-es oeuxtrrcae ,e nxtoe nclsoiounds s oync T — OR fu —lly eoaffclihn ere.duces anonymity.

Email Address Tools & Phone Number Tools

21 Email Address Tools

Tool	Function
GHunt	Info from Gmail accounts
EPIEOS	Email reverse lookup
OSINT Industries	Email reverse lookup
Castrick	Email reverse lookup
Holehe	Check email in different sites
Mailcat	Find email by nickname
EmailRep.io	Email reputation checker
HavelBeenPwned	Search data breaches
DeHashed	Search data breaches
BreachDirectory	Search data breaches
Whoxy	Lookup domain WHOIS
Reverse Whois	Domain WHOIS search
That's Them	People search engine
InsE	Instagram email finder
osint.rocks	Email tools collection
Skymem	Find emails of companies
SignalHire	Find professional emails
Hunter.io	Find professional emails
Simple Login	Mask your email address
Proton Mail	Free & secure email service
Scamsearch.io	Scammer details database

21 Phone Number Tools

Tool	Function
Free Carrier Lookup	Carrier identification
Carrier Lookup	Carrier identification
Twilio	Number lookup service
Apeiron	Number lookup service
Truecaller	Number lookup service
Spy Dialer	Number lookup service
EPIEOS	Phone reverse lookup
OSINT Industries	Phone reverse lookup
Castrick	Phone reverse lookup
Google	General search engine
Bing	General search engine
UniversalSearchBot	Telegram phone search bot
Phoneinfoga	Info gathering framework
NumLookup	Reverse phone lookup
osint.rocks	Multiple OSINT tools
WhatssApp Checkleaked	WhatsApp profile information
WhitePages	Phone numbers database
DeHashed	Search data breaches
Detectdee	Check phones on sites
Ignorant	Check phones on sites
Havelbeenzuckered	Facebook data breach checker

Dark Web Tools & SOCMINT Intelligence

21 Dark Web Tools

TOR Browser Web browser for the dark web	**Ahmia** Dark web search engine	**HayStack** Dark web search engine
Tor66 Dark web search engine	**Torch** Dark web search engine	**Onion Engine** Dark web search engine
Telemetry Telegram search tool	**Library of Leaks** Leaks & breaches	**HavelBeenPwned** Search data breaches
DeHashed Search data breaches	**LeakOSINT** Telegram bot for leaks	**UniversalSearchBot** Telegram search bot
DeepDarkCTI Collection of CTI sources	**DarkwebDaily.Live** Links to onion sites	**Onion.live** Links to onion sites
Tor.link Links to onion sites	**The Hidden Wiki** Links to onion sites	**TorCrawl.py** Crawl and extract webpages
Aleph Search data on the Dark Web	**TOR2web** Access to Tor hidden services	**PGP Tool** Encrypt, decrypt, and verify PGP

SOCMINT Tools by Platform

Facebook

Instant Data Scraper Extracts data from webpages and exports as Excel/CSV

ESUIT Download photos, videos, comments, likes, posts

HavelBeenZuckered Check if phone number is in Facebook data breach

FB Sleep Stats Gather data about Facebook users sleep patterns

Inteltechniques Facebook Search Tool Search for detailed info on Facebook

Instagram

Turbo Downloader Download photos, videos and reels

ESuit Export followers, comments, likes, emails, phones

Toutatis Extract emails, phones, etc. from profiles

Instaloader Scrape public and private profiles, hashtags, stories

Inteltechniques IG Search Tool Search for detailed info on Instagram

X / Twitter

Tweetdeck (X Pro) Organize and monitor multiple Twitter feeds in real-time

Deleted Tweet Finder Search for deleted tweets across archival services

Twint Scrape X profiles without relying on X's API

Warble Email alerts for Twitter activity

Inteltechniques Twitter Search Tool Search for detailed info on Twitter

TikTok

Bravedown Download videos and stories from TikTok

TikTok Scraper Scrape TikTok followers from any public profile

Hashtag Analysis Download posts and videos for a given hashtag

Export Comments Exports comments and posts to Excel file

OSINT Combine TikTok Quick Search Search usernames and hashtags via browser

◆EXEC ·

Executive Protection & VIP Security

Integrating OSINTinto ExecutiveProtectionstrategiesprovidessecurityteamswithvaluable intelligence to proactively mitigate risks and ensure the safety of the executive.

VIP Individuals

- Executives & CEOs
- Political Figures
- Celebrities
- High Net Worth Individuals
- Dignitaries
- Professional Athletes
- Musicians & Actors
- Other VIPs

7 Essential OSINT Steps (Checklist)

1. **Personal Information & Media Analysis** Identify personal info and media of the executive, relatives and associates. Check for home, vehicle, email, phone, and password exposure.

2. **Threat Detection & Risk Monitoring** Monitor online chatter, social media conversations, and forums for any threats, harassment, or hostile sentiment directed towards the executive.

3. **Social Media Vulnerability Assessment** Explore executive's and family social media profiles to assess interests, habits, and potential vulnerabilities. Check privacy settings.

4. **Travel & Accommodation Risk Assessment** Assess security risks associated with travel destinations, transportation arrangements, and accommodations.

5. **Reputation Management & Media Monitoring** Monitor online mentions, reviews, and news coverage related to the executive's reputation, brand image, and professional activities.

6. **Cybersecurity Threat Identification** Identify compromised accounts, leaked credentials, or other indicators of cyber threats targeting digital assets.

7. **Physical Security & Vulnerability Mapping** Recognize potential security vulnerabilities, access points, and emergency exits for relevant locations.

Primary Risks & Threat Categories

Primary Risks

Personal Data Exposure Social media accounts contain personal info — photos, locations, activities, and connections.

Exposed Home Address Allows malicious individuals to locate and potentially harm them in their own residence.

Exposed Email or Phone Can lead to harassment, phishing attempts, extortion or blackmail.

Predictable Routine Knowing daily activities allows malicious individuals to anticipate movements and exploit vulnerabilities.

Exposed Credentials Unauthorized access to sensitive information, financial accounts, or critical systems.

Threat Categories

Physical Threat Vulnerability to assault, kidnapping, burglaries or harassment. Risks from civil unrest. Corporate espionage or sabotage.

Digital Threat Monitoring of data breaches and vulnerabilities. Cyber threats targeting digital assets. Reputational damage if sensitive info is leaked.

Indirect Threat Threats against family members or personal relationships. Indirect threats against business or employees.

Actions to Minimize Risks

- Lockdown executive and family members' personal social media.
- Regular monitoring of online chatter, social media, and news reports.
- Background check services to vet individuals and organizations.
- Change breached passwords. Create unique passwords for all accounts.
- Request "right to erasure" for platforms sharing PII.
- Search for information about travel plans, itineraries, and future events.
- Conduct a comprehensive search of the executive's digital footprint.
- Share with law enforcement direct and credible threats.

OSINT Investigation Tips & Soft Skills

8 OSINT Investigation Tips

OPSEC: Your Essential Shield Lower adversary exploitation risk. Stay anonymous. Keep activities hard to trace.	**The Golden Rule of Verification** The accuracy of information is paramount. Not all sources are reliable. Verified data is crucial.
Develop Technical Skills Become acquainted with essential OSINT tools and master advanced search strategies.	**Customer Focus** Understand the customer's goals and priorities; focus on gathering the most valuable information.
Pivot, Pivot & Pivot Become flexible in transitioning between data points and sources. Gather extensive, confirmed data.	**Stay Up-To-Date** Join an OSINT community; monitor social media, listen to podcasts, attend workshops, read blogs.
Think Creatively Be creative in your approach to finding information. Consider unconventional sources or methods.	**Document Your Way to Intelligence** Keep thorough documentation of findings including sources and methodologies employed.

10 Soft Skills to Accelerate Your OSINT Career

Technicalskills cansecureyou a job— butinterpersonalskillswilladvanceyour career.

1. Analytical Thinking Identify relevant information. Spot patterns. Evaluate data credibility.	**2. Attention to Detail** Ensure accuracy. Avoid missing details. Prevent incorrect conclusions.
3. Critical Thinking Question assumptions. Assess source validity. Make sound judgments.	**4. Communication Skills** Convey findings clearly. Ensure understanding. Present complex info simply.
5. Problem-Solving Tackle unique challenges. Develop innovative strategies. Find effective solutions.	**6. Curiosity** Dig deeper. Learn new tools. Stay updated with industry developments.
7. Adaptability Adjust to changes. Use new tools effectively. Stay relevant.	**8. Ethical Judgment** Handle sensitive info responsibly. Maintain integrity. Make ethical decisions.
9. Collaboration Work well in teams. Share insights. Achieve common goals.	**10. Time Management** Prioritize tasks. Meet deadlines. Manage workload efficiently.

AI + OSINT — Definitions, Strategies & Tools

Key AIDefinitions

Artificial Intelligence (AI)	Natural Language Processing (NLP)	Machine Learning (ML)	Generative AI	Computer Vision
Technology that makes machines smart, allowing them to do tasks that usually need human thinking.	A technology that helps computers understand and work with human language, like speech and text.	A way for computers to learn from data and improve performance over time without being explicitly programmed.	A type of AI that creates new content — images, music, or text — based on what it has learned.	Technology that enables computers to see, interpret, and understand the visual world, like recognizing objects in photos.

OSINT & AI Strategies

Data Collection AI algorithms automate data gathering from online sources. NLP extracts information from unstructured text data.	**Data Analysis** Machine learning and deep learning for quick analysis of OSINT data. Identify patterns, trends, anomalies, and correlations.
Image & Video Analysis Automatically detect and analyze objects, faces, logos, and text within multimedia content.	**Content Generation** Write reports, generate summaries, or produce visualizations based on collected OSINT data.
Sentiment Analysis Analyze sentiment in text data from social media and news articles. Gauge public opinion and detect emerging trends.	**Identification & Entity Recognition** Automatically identify people, organizations, or locations. Track activities of specific individuals or groups.
Risk Assessment Assess credibility and reliability of OSINT sources using AI algorithms.	

OSINT & AI Tools

ChatGPT Rapidly analyze vast data for actionable insights. Automate and enhance threat intelligence gathering.	**Copilot** Simplify complex data for rapid intelligence interpretation. Generate clear insights from diverse information sources.	**Geospy** AI tool to analyze images and determine their location. Correlates with geospatial data.
FaceCheck.id Reverse image search tool focused on faces and people. Upload a photo to find matching images.	**Consensus** Academic search engine powered by AI. Search over 200M papers across all domains of science.	**AskNews App** Compare global news perspectives from 50,000+ sources. Track event development over time.
MyMapAI Create context-rich diagrams from diverse data sources. Summarize web data for quick visualization.		

10 Key Considerations for AI in OSINT

1. Avoid using AI tools for sensitive data to prevent exposure.	2. Choose AI tools that fit your investigation's specific needs.
3. Weigh costs of AI automation against doing it manually.	4. Double-check sources to avoid incorporating incorrect information.

5. Always confirm AI findings with human review.	6. Regularly evaluate AI's impact on investigation quality.
7. Use AI to speed up, not replace, human analysis.	8. Limit AI use to avoid over-reliance on it.
9. Watch for biases in AI-generated insights.	10. Be cautious of over-complicating simple tasks with AI.

◆CAREERS ·

60 High-Demand Jobs in Open Source Intelligence

Government

- OSINT Analyst — Conduct open source intelligence for national security.
- Cyber Intelligence Analyst — Monitor and analyze cyber threats.
- Intelligence Officer — Use OSINT to support defense and security operations.
- Counterterrorism Analyst — Analyze open-source information toprevent terrorism.
- Law Enforcement Intelligence Analyst — Support law enforcement operations.
- Border Security Analyst — Utilize OSINT for monitoring and securing borders.
- Public Health Intelligence Officer — Use OSINT to track public health threats.
- Diplomatic Security Analyst — Provide security analysis for diplomatic missions.
- Military Intelligence Analyst — Support military operations with OSINT.
- Threat Analyst — Identify and analyze threats to national security.

Private Sector

- Corporate Security Analyst — Use OSINT to protect corporate assets.
- Fraud Investigator — Investigate fraud using open source data.
- Cyber Threat Analyst — Monitor and mitigate cyber threats.
- SOC Analyst — Monitor and analyze security events.
- Brand Protection Specialist — Monitor and protect brand reputation.
- Due Diligence Investigator — Conduct background checks and investigations.
- Incident Response Analyst — Utilize OSINT during cyber incident investigations.
- Digital Forensics Investigator — Use OSINT in digital forensics investigations.
- Red Team Operator — Use OSINT to plan and execute simulated cyber attacks.
- Competitive Intelligence Analyst — Analyze market and competitor information.

Technology & Software

- OSINT Tool Developer — Develop software tools for OSINT gathering.
- Data Engineer — Design and manage systems that process andanalyze OSINT.
- Machine Learning Engineer — Implement ML models to analyze OSINT data.
- Software Engineer — Build applications for OSINT analysis and visualization.
- Data Scientist — Use statistical and computational techniques toextract insights.
- AIResearcher — Develop AI algorithms to enhance OSINT capabilities.
- Web Scraping Specialist — Create scripts and tools to collect datafrom web sources.
- Geospatial Analyst — Analyze spatial data from open sources forintel purposes.
- Cybersecurity Software Developer — Develop security software using OSINT.
- Cloud Architect — Design cloud infrastructure to support OSINT operations.

Freelance & Consultancy

- Freelance OSINT Investigator — Offer OSINT services on a contract basis.
- Security Consultant — Provide security analysis using open-source intelligence.
- Private Investigator — Use OSINT for private investigations.
- Risk Consultant — Offer risk assessments using open sources.
- Social Media Consultant — Analyze social media trends for clients.
- Cybersecurity Consultant — Provide cybersecurity services using OSINT.
- Competitive Intelligence Consultant — Advise businesses on market intelligence.
- Crisis Management Consultant — Use OSINT to manage crises.
- Brand Protection Consultant — Help businesses protect their brand using OSINT.
- KYC / AML Consultant — Provide KYC and AML services using OSINT.

Journalism & Academia

- Investigative Journalist — Use OSINT to uncover stories and investigate issues.
- Research Analyst — Conduct open-source research for academic studies.
- Cybersecurity Researcher — Investigate cybersecurity threats using OSINT.
- OSINT Author — Write books and articles on OSINT techniques and applications.
- Fact-Checker — Verify the accuracy of information using open-source data.
- Foreign Correspondent — Use OSINT to report on international news.
- Intelligence Studies Professor — Teach and research OSINT methodologies.
- OSINT Instructor — Provide training and teach courses on open-source intelligence.
- Business Reporter — Analyze and report on business trends and market data.
- Data Scientist — Analyze open-source data for academic research.

Non-Profit Organizations

- Human Rights Researcher — Use OSINT to document human rights abuses.
- Environmental Research Analyst — Monitor environmental issues using OSINT.
- Crisis Response Analyst — Use OSINT to respond to humanitarian crises.
- NGO Security Analyst — Ensure the security of non-profit operations with OSINT.
- Transparency Investigator — Investigate corruption and promote transparency.
- Social Media Analyst — Monitor social media for advocacy and awareness.
- Policy Analyst — Use OSINT to inform policy recommendations.
- Public Health Researcher — Track and analyze public health data.
- Conflict Researcher — Monitor and analyze conflicts using open sources.
- Disaster Response Analyst — Use OSINT for disaster preparedness and response.

European Business Data — OSINT Resources

GERMANY

Handelsregister
https://www.handelsregister.de

Bundesanzeiger
https://www.bundesanzeiger.de

Unternehmensregister
https://www.unternehmensregister.de

Creditreform
https://firmeneintrag.creditreform.de

North Data
https://www.northdata.de

UNITED KINGDOM

CompaniesHouse
https://www.gov.uk

Opencorporates
https://opencorporates.com

The Gazette
https://www.thegazette.co.uk

Company Check
https://www.companycheck.co.uk

Bizstats
https://bizstats.co.uk

FRANCE

Infogreffe
https://www.infogreffe.fr

Societe
https://www.societe.com

Pappers
https://www.pappers.fr

Verif
https://www.verif.com

BODACC
https://www.bodacc.fr

ITALY

Registrodelle Imprese
https://www.registroimprese.it

Infocamere
https://www.infocamere.it

Empresite
https://www.empresite.it

Opencorporates
https://opencorporates.com

Pagine Gialle
https://www.paginegialle.it

RUSSIA

EGRUL
https://egrul.nalog.ru

Rusprofile
https://www.rusprofile.ru

Zachestnyibiznes
https://zachestnyibiznes.ru

List-org
https://www.list-org.com

Kontur Focus
https://focus.kontur.ru

SPAIN

RegistroMercantil Central
https://www.rmc.es

BORME
https://www.boe.es

Axesor
https://www.axesor.es

Librebor.me
https://librebor.me

Datoscif
https://www.datoscif.es

NETHERLANDS

Kamer van Koophandel (KvK)
https://www.kvk.nl

OpenKvK
https://openkvk.nl

Drimble
https://drimble.nl

DNB Business Register
https://www.dnb.nl/en/public-register

Dun & Bradstreet
https://www.dnb.com

SWITZERLAND

Zefix
https://www.zefix.ch

SIX Swiss Exchange
https://www.six-group.com

SHAB
https://www.shab.ch

Moneyhouse
https://www.moneyhouse.ch

Swissreg
https://www.swissreg.ch

◆ADVANCED ·

Advanced OSINT Platforms & Brand Intelligence

8 Advanced OSINT Platforms

Maltego	Social Links Crimewall	Skopenow	NexusXplore
■ Rapid OSINT searches and complex investigations	■ OSINT and SOCMINT across 500+ sources	■ Instant aggregated data for actionable insights	■ GEOINT for real-time, location-specific insights
■ Collect, cross-correlate, and store intelligence	■ Graph, table, and map visualizations	■ Object recognition, analytics and automated reports	■ Robust public and corporate records access
■ Monitor and analyze large volumes of data instantly	■ ML-driven analysis & real-time monitoring	■ Visualize intelligence in a variety of layouts	■ Secure, anonymized dark web and OSINT browsing
DarkOwl Vision UI	**Talkwalker**	**Blackdot Solutions Videris**	**Onyx Fivecast**
■ Real-time threat monitoring with darknet data	■ Powerful social listening for team-wide data access	■ OSINT platform for efficient large-scale investigations	■ Fast, broad digital footprint mapping
■ Automated alerts and customizable search tools	■ Effective media monitoring and brand performance	■ Visualize networks and corporate links clearly	■ AI-driven risk assessment across vast data sources
■ Advanced exposure metrics to assess cyber risk	■ Benchmarking to track industry and competitors	■ Rapid, AI-driven risk detection and prioritization	■ Scalable OSINT solution for deep data collection

OSINT for Brand Intelligence

Byleveraging OSINT,brandscanproactivelymanage their reputation, respond swiftly to potential issues, and continuously align their strategies with customer expectations and market dynamics.

8 Main Strategies

Real-Time Monitoring OSINT tools continuously scan social media, forums, and news sites to track what is being said about a brand.	**Sentiment Analysis** Advanced OSINT tools include sentiment analysis features to categorize brand mentions as positive, negative, or neutral.	**Crisis Management** Early detection of negative mentions helps brands respond promptly before issues escalate.
Competitor Insights By monitoring competitors, OSINT provides valuable information about their activities and public perception.	**Influencer Engagement** OSINT can identify key influencers and thought leaders who have significant influence over public opinion.	**Customer Feedback** Feedback can be used to improve products, services, and customer support to enhance brand reputation.
Market & Trend Analysis Understanding customer wants and predicting future trends helps in making strategic decisions.	**Internal Monitoring** OSINT ensures employees represent the brand well online and identifies internal issues.	

Negative Effects of Poor Reputation

- Competitive Disadvantage
- Decreased Sales
- Brand Devaluation
- Negative Media Coverage
- Employee Turnover
- Loss of Trust
- Legal Scrutiny
- Lower Profitability
- Social Media Backlash
- Increased Costs

Why is it Essential?

Customer Trust & Loyalty A strong reputation fosters trust and encourages customer loyalty.

Competitive Advantage It can be a deciding factor for consumers when choosing between similar products.

Crisis Resilience Brands with strong reputations are better able to withstand negative events.

Attracting Talent Companies with good reputations are more attractive to top talent.

Financial Performance Command higher prices, achieve better market positions, and attract more investment.

Actions to Enhance Reputation

- Build and maintain positive online media relations
- Ensure excellent online customer service
- Encourage and showcase positive online reviews
- Leverage influencer and brand ambassador partnerships
- Monitor and respond to online feedback
- Engage with your online audience
- Promote online Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)
- Create and share high-quality content

6 Key OSINT Steps for Investigating the Dark Web

1. Define Clear Objectives Before diving in, define specific objectives — whether tracking illegal activity, identifying cyber threats, or gathering intelligence on a specific group.

2. Maintain OPSEC Use virtual machines (VMs) to minimize malware risk. Employ Tor Browser or I2P for anonymous browsing. Consider VPNs. Enable strong firewalls and multi-factor authentication.

3. Identify Relevant Marketplaces & Forums Identify relevant sites through dark web search engines like Ahmia.fi, OSINT databases that track known dark web sites, or dark web forums.

4. Gather & Analyze Metadata Analyze site uptime, traffic, and server details. Review timestamps, file formats, and server responses. Collect Bitcoin transaction metadata if investigating cryptocurrency payments.

5. Monitor Threat Actors & Activity Observe chatter in forums, marketplaces, and social media. Use automated web crawlers to track activity related to targets of interest. Leverage OSINT tools that scrape the dark web.

6. Analyze Cryptocurrency Transactions Use blockchain explorers like Blockchair or CipherTrace to trace wallet addresses linked to dark web markets. Look for patterns of movement or laundering activities.

Browser Extensions & 40 Online Communities

21 Browser Extensions for OSINT Professionals

uBlock Origin Blocks ads and trackers	**Cookie AutoDelete** Control and auto-delete cookies	**Google Translate** Translate text on any webpage	**RevEye** Reverse image search
Privacy Badger Block tracking scripts	**DownThemAll** Bulk download files from websites	**Exif Viewer** View image metadata	**Vortimo** Analyze web content for OSINT
Instant Data Scraper Data scraper for web pages	**Wayback Machine** Access web archives	**Fireshot** Screen capture entire pages	**Context Search** Quickly search selected text
User-Agent Switcher Modify your user-agent string	**Sputnik** Search digital identifiers	**Video DownloadHelper** Download videos from websites	**Shodan** Retrieve website information
Forensic OSINT Screen capture with annotations	**ESUIT** Facebook content downloader	**Hunchly** Capture and organize web pages	**Bot Sentinel** Detect bots on X/Twitter
Hive AI Detector Detect AI-generated media			

40 Online Communities for POI Investigations

Strava Fitness tracking app	**Garmin Connect** Fitness tracking app	**Tripadvisor** Travel reviews platform	**Booking Reviews** Travel booking site	**Trustpilot** Business reviews website
Google Reviews Customer review platform	**Amazon Reviews** Online shopping marketplace	**Yelp** Local business reviews	**Google Store** Google product shop (Reviews)	**Apple Store** Apple products store (Reviews)
Komoot Outdoor activity planner	**Reddit** Online discussion forum	**4chan** Anonymous message board	**Discord** Voice, video, and chat	**Twitch** Livestreaming platform
Steam Video game marketplace	**Tumblr** Microblogging social network	**Foursquare** Location check-in app	**Flickr** Photo sharing platform	**Bluesky** Alternative to Twitter/X
Medium Blogging and writing site	**Blogger** Simple blogging platform	**Goodreads** Book reviews site	**Nextdoor** Neighborhood social network	**PayPal** Online payment service
Meetup Group event organizer	**GitHub** Code repository platform	**Craigslist** Classifieds advertisement site	**Pinterest** Visual inspiration platform	**Gettr** Conservative social media
Gab Free speech network	**Duolingo** Language learning app	**Gravatar** One-page personal site	**Academia.edu** Research sharing site	**SoundCloud** Music sharing platform

Myspace Early social network	**Skype** Video calling platform	**OnlyFans** Subscription content platform	**Tinder** Dating app	**Badoo** Dating app

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